Competitive Analysis: Project Platforms | Prepared by Tessa Grant, October 2026

Purpose

This analysis supports the 2027 planning cycle: where Nexus competes, against whom, and where the open ground is. It covers the two competitors we meet most in deals, Taskforge and Planora, with the status quo (spreadsheets and chat) noted where it matters. A third entrant, Workstack, is growing quickly in our segment and is named here for completeness.

The Market

Project platforms are a $4.2B market growing at 18% a year. Buyers are consolidating: teams that once ran a task app, a wiki, and a spreadsheet increasingly want one workspace, which is the motion Nexus is built for.

Competitor: Taskforge

Task-first and proud of it. A clean board, quick setup, and a loyal base among teams under 20 people. Docs arrived in 2025 and reports in 2026, both thinner than the board they support. Per their pricing page (March 2025), Pro is $9 per member per month and there is no mobile app, so their users work around both. We meet Taskforge when a team has outgrown it: docs have moved to a wiki, the roadmap is a spreadsheet, and status has become a Friday project.

Where they are strong: price, simplicity, and a first run a new team finishes in minutes. Where they are weak: everything past the board. Their roadmap has been announced and unshipped since their 2024 acquisition.

Competitor: Planora

Roadmap-first. Planora sells the view leadership reads: portfolio timelines, capacity, and polished reporting, with task management underneath. Their homepage reports 99.99% uptime and more than 10,000 teams, and their sales story is built on the leadership demo. We meet Planora in larger accounts where the buyer is a director choosing for teams she does not sit in.

Where they are strong: the leadership view, and reporting a director can forward. Where they are weak: the daily work surface. Teams we interview describe the boards as serviceable and the docs as an afterthought (two interviews, fall 2026).

The Status Quo

Spreadsheets and chat remain the most common setup we find, especially under 15 people. They cost nothing and coordinate nothing: no permissions, no shared state, and a status answer that lives in whoever updated the sheet last.

Where the Open Ground Is

The under-20 segment is the volume opportunity. It is the largest pool of teams, it adopts tools fastest, and neither Taskforge's depth nor Planora's reporting speaks to it. Nexus should aim its 2027 growth motion at teams under 20 people, where a simple start matters more than sprint depth or roadmap reporting.

What This Means for Nexus

- Keep the board's first run as fast as Taskforge's; it is the price of entry everywhere.
- Win the over-20 segment on the unified workspace: docs, sprints, and roadmap in one place is a claim neither competitor can make today.
- Aim the growth motion at the under-20 segment, per the open ground above.